

Making LEMONADE

THE 10 PRINCIPLES

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Before you pin this to anything

These are the ten principles from *Making Lemonade*, gathered in one place so you don't have to go hunting for them at midnight.

They aren't steps. There's no order to get right, no schedule you're behind on, and none of it expires. Some will land years apart. One will hit you in a grocery store parking lot with no warning at all. So use them like a light switch, not a treadmill: pick the one that matches the day you're actually having. And on the days when not one of them helps, put the last page on the fridge and go do something ordinary. The principles will keep.

So will you.

Lauren

1

Tell the truth.

Before the breakup, before the confrontation, before the grieving or the rebuilding, stop abandoning yourself to protect the story.

Where are you still editing the story to keep the peace?

2

See it clearly.

No prosecution, no victim or villain. Seeing what actually happened, including your own part in it, is what makes healing possible.

What did you see clearly long before you let yourself believe it?

3

Let it hurt.

Grief isn't an identity, it's integration. Stop forcing pain to perform normalcy before it's had the chance to move through you.

What are you performing fine about right now?

4

Protect yourself like the asset you are.

Protection means limiting your exposure to the source of the pain. You know the stove is hot. Stop touching it to check.

What are you still touching to check?

5

Be the closure.

Closure isn't handed to you by the other person. It's a decision you make when you stop waiting for an apology that may never come.

Whose apology are you still waiting on?

6

Radical acceptance. Radical honesty. Radical accountability.

"It's not just you. It's also me." Accountability means asking what actually fits you, not why you can't be like everyone else.

What actually fits you, regardless of what fits everyone else?

7

Honor your own ecology.

There is no universal bloom. Know what conditions help you grow versus shrink. You're not every flower, you're yours.

Which conditions make you grow, and which ones quietly shrink you?

8

"Don't let anyone choose you. Remember that you choose, not the other way around."

Choose yourself first. Let everything else prove it belongs in your life, not the other way around.

Where have you been letting someone else do the choosing?

9

Use what you know to become who you choose.

Stop building around who you used to be. Stop making another person your North Star. You're the one you steer by.

Who have you been steering by?

10

The kitchen ain't closed, but seating is limited.

You're open again: warmth, appetite, something worth sharing, but not for just anyone. Selectivity isn't closure, it's standards.

Who has earned a seat lately, and how did you know?

That's all ten.

The last page is the one to tear off. Put it wherever your resolve tends to wobble: the fridge, the mirror, the inside of a cabinet door where nobody but you will see it.

One small ask, zero obligation. I write letters about heartbreak, hard conversations, self-worth, and the beautifully complicated business of being human. If you want them, they're at laurenonlife.com. If you don't, keep the guide anyway. It's yours either way.

And if you found these principles before you found the book they came from, *Making Lemonade* is wherever books are sold.

Lauren



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from Making Lemonade by Lauren Florek

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- 2 See it clearly.
- 3 Let it hurt.
- 4 Protect yourself like the asset you are.
- 5 Be the closure.
- 6 Radical acceptance. Radical honesty. Radical accountability.
- 7 Honor your own ecology.
- 8 "Don't let anyone choose you. Remember that you choose, not the other way around."
- 9 Use what you know to become who you choose.
- 10 The kitchen ain't closed, but seating is limited.